R. Campbell Thompson 1930 – Notes (end of Tablet X notes through Tablet XI notes)

<!-- UNCORRECTED archive.org OCR (djvu.txt of item 'epicgilgamish0000rcam'), lines 6560-6835 of the OCR file, extracted 2026-10-16. Diacritics, line numbers and transliterations are frequently garbled: always check against the PDF page images. -->

Gilgamish, by his destruction of them, hinders his journey, and thereafter, in c
proceed, he must cut poles to punt the boat. Then as they come in sight of Uta-n
the latter sees that the [SU. UT. TAK. ME S| are destroyed.

Then, of course, the most obvious explanation would be ‘sails’, visible from afa
the story of Aegeus and the forgotten sail of Theseus); probably of reed or fibr
copse, not at all times of the year available, but it is hard to find a philolog
Nor can wvnu be connected with any known plant-name, for wrnxd@ (long z) ‘ mint’
is impossible here.

33. Cf. Tablet IX, Col. I, 15, and perhaps VIII, Col. II, 4. There is, however,
certainty that all the missing parts are to be supplied from these other texts.
tttardas|sunu|t are difficult: Za/é/u = ‘pierce, bore a hole’, and z¢tarda, from
down ’, is uncertain.

Cox. III, 41. Partsu: cf. the new Esarhaddon prism from Nineveh, Col. IV, 84, Au
imrsqsé?!_e sa-an-du par-ri-sa-ni ‘are yoked rowers instead of horses’ (to their
parisu must here be a punting-pole and not a paddle (although the de//am or mash
skiff of the Babylonian marshes, use both) for the following reasons :—(1) Gilga
makes 120 of them, so that he may throw each away after it is wet, that the ‘ Wa
may not touch him (if this is the way the incident is to be explained): this wou
necessary for a paddle in which the handle can always be kept dry; (2) the fashi
poles ‘ Bitumen (them) and put a socket’ (kupur-ma Sukun tulad), The punting-pol
Mesopotamian skiff to-day has a knob of bitumen at the upper end (called £¢va) a
socket or ferule (called legma = lakma) at the lower end. With ¢w/é cf. Syriac ?
and Heb. ?/u ‘handle’, and Aram. ¢adyé ‘plug’.

Cot. IV, 2. There is no doubt about the reading of the first word, for which Hau
unt-mes-te,

g. U. correctly ‘léste seinen Gurt [...]’.

Io. Difficult: U. ‘zog aus (?) [seine] Klei[dung]’ followed by E.

11. Difficult: if £arvd is the mast, it is difficult to see why Gilgamish steps
at the end of the voyage, although the appearance of the bare mast might explain
tim’s question to himself about the absence of the sails. See J7A. s.v., quoting

cedar (?).

Cot. V, 25. as-hur al-h-ka, lit. ‘1 turned (and) came’, i.e. I came again.

gi. The reading appears to be certain at the end of the line: ‘cattle and beasts desert’.)

Cot. VI, 30. Aullu, name of a bird in C7. xiv, 7, K. 4206, obv. 8 = &i-L-lum: Houghton (7:SBA. vit, 67) ‘woodpecker’, but I have never seen this bird in Mesop Kulilu, kuliltu, kulihtum is a small creature, probably a water-cricket (= HU.SA ‘river locust’): cf. Dennefeld, Geburts., 199: Boissier, Zextes, 246: AM. 77, 4, = kulukuku = kakullum (CT. xiv, 6, rev. 5, or ku-lu-ku-u, ibid. 7, K. 4205, 1) p of Zuluhuku, Langdon, UMBS. x, 2, 199, 31 (an offering to Shamash, and so presum either an eatable or decorative bird). Houghton (ibid. 85) compares the Arab. £@ partridge’.

35. Instead of ‘servant (and) master’ should it be amelu-u ””e-til ‘is a man mas the -z being the question-mark and e/2/, as predicate, in the indefinite ?

OB. version (Meissner, ZV AG. 1902, I, 6).

Cor. I, 11. There is some doubt about the reading 4ak-ka-bu which makes little s and I would suggest (from the photograph) £ak-ka-di. Pinches (see PSBA. 1903, 11

bu-um ma-du-u.

Cox. II, 7. For 2/u read la?

g. Ebeling ‘bis der Wurm in seine Nase eindrang’, making the @&z as equivalent t Zimmern followed OZ. in his restoration of AV. ZA. xxxv, 1923, 154, ‘liess nicht begraben, bis dass Wiirmer in seine Nase eindrangen’, It would appear from all e tultu is the white maggot of corruption which eats dried figs, with a special on CT, xiv, 10, rev. 17: the red earth worms are apparently UZU.D/R = kamunu (see m article RAS. 1929, 343). Are we to read ‘My friend came not to my call for seven

and seven nights, until the worm entered his nose'? But why should the worms 'en nose ', rather than any other part of his body? Although it is tempting to see i the worm of corruption, it is not easy to accept it as a translation here.

TABLE ee

a1. Kzkks and zgar, very obvious instances of the indefinite in the vocative.

24. 'Uproot (thy) house and build a boat,' which seems to go back to the earlies when both houses and boats were built of reeds. The later houses of mud-brick of roof only would have a few rafters of wood can hardly be intended.

29. Lu-u-min-du-da (}.) is a difficult form: it is much more probably /u-u-nzs-d I permans.) from sadddu ' draw', (esp.) 'calculate'.

44. The new fragment shows the missing word to be puzur, not dw'ur.

46. [lua Sse-ir?] ku-wk-ki [ina h-la-a-tt u)\-sa-az-na-na-ku-nu-si Sa-mu-tu ki-b also in ll. 87, 90. A very difficult passage. JZu-zr is possible, but the other J. translates 1. 87 '(wenn) dze Gebceter der Finsternis an einem Abend einen Sch regnen lassen werdex': U. 'Die Regenten(?) der Finsternis(?) werden eines Abends niedergehen lassen einen furchtbaren(?) Regen'. Langdon (7RAS. 1925, 720), ' Whe senders of hail cause a hailstorm to rain in the night-time'.

Kukku, as J. (485) points out, is the equivalent for the character GUG (Lr. No. which has also the values dalifu, mardsu, |rahdsu| (?, SAT. 4922), and [dalélu)] so that the accepted meaning 'darkness' is satisfactory, with which the,Syriac £ darkness' is comparable. But, as J. remarks, who can the senders of darkness be? in ll. 87, 90 to show that a particularly obvious occasion (adannw) is foretold, occurs, so that Uta-napishtim knows that the Flood is coming. At the same time, beginning, when he is warned to leave Shuruppak and build a boat, Ea provides hi explanation to satisfy the townsfolk, so that they may be deceived to the last m

'LO MorlJtal (?), thus shalt thou say to them,
"Me [alo]ne doth Enlil hate, and
I may not dwell in your [city],
Nor to Enlil's dry land may I set my face:

I will go down to the Deep, dwelling with Ea, my lord,
“Tis on you he shall rain plenty,
of birds, a lair for fishes
ae increase (of) the harvest
(It shall be) [on a morn] of storm,
(When) the heavens shall pour down on you heavy rains (?) [in the twilight]”’.

If we read zua Se-zy and not m-zr, it may mean on that stormy morning of winter, twilight (4/é¢¢) of which the god sends the rain. On the other hand, Frank (ZA. has an ingenious and tempting explanation that the lines contain a play on words ing both ‘bran’ and ‘darkness’, and -£26ét2 ‘wheat’ and ‘oppression’, so that wh townspeople think he is telling them that ‘the sender of bran will let rain down

eee)
wheat-rain ’, he is really saying ‘the sender of darkness will let the showers r oppression ’.

I do not think that Langdon’s explanation that kukku = chickpeas, and s7zbatz = = hailstorm, is satisfactory.

57. GAN. HI-sa, or perhaps far-{-sa (Syr. Frak ‘ defined’).

65. A?zru, variant Br. 8976. J. ‘Innenraum’, U. ‘Innenwand’. Haupt ‘six sars of asphalt I poured into the pitchpot’ (BA. 1927, 22), followed by E. ‘ Brennofen’ Gadd, Ur Luscr., 32).

68. Mzkku: U. ‘das Opfer(?)’: I have suggested ‘tackling’ (?). Mesu = ‘offering’ as contrary to zz#é in 1. 155 seems impossible.

78. Gur tarkullé(?). The character is not ¢arkul/u, although similar. Cf. Deimel Sum. Lex. 314, and cf. 1. ror. '

95. For the dimensions of the ark and the animals, see also K. 1520 (Johns, Ass. II, No. 777).

99. Not necessarily Nabi, and certainly not Adad here. “PA may be also “ISum or uSarru (CT. xxxv, 7) or ™Nergal sa suki (CT. xxiv, 41, 74), and for "LUGAL see S and 10583 (= zur zi ‘light of the gods’).

106. Uttrru, prop. active (and not as I have it in the translation).

134. UsSallu, not usallu, Ungnad, ZA. 1928, 200.

153. Karura sa mé, cf. Arab. karra ‘rest, be fixed’, like hithp. of Heb. £érar.

154. JLtarri, tard, cf. Syr. ?r? ‘was moistened’. E. ‘ Er frisst, mistet, krachz

164. For sepru = ‘sapphire’, see my Ox the Chemistry, s.v. and note also Lenorma ISLA. VI, 339.

212. /srz,imper. fem. from esévu ‘mark’, i.e. she is to count the days he sleeps line 214, uddassu).

215. Jensen (KZ. vi, 511) held that this difficult passage might indicate seven ent loaves of bread. Haupt, I think more correctly, suggested (A ¥SZ. xxvi, 16) shows the making of bread. Gressmann (GZ. 141, note 4) follows Haupt: ‘Sicher sc mir dass v. 224 ff., die verschiedenen Stadien des Brotbackens geschildert werde technici vorliegen, sind sie fiir uns schwer verstandlich’. Jensen, however, is accept this (OZZ. 1929, 647) ‘Es ist nun durchaus méglich, dass an sechs Brote i denen Stadien ihres Entstehens und Vergehens zu denken ist.’

In spite of Gressmann’s concluding remark, it is possible, I think, to follow mo the process. In one point, however, I must admit I was wrong in translating kuru ‘flour’ (as Jensen points out): the meaning here is the usual one, ‘rations’, ‘f particularly the vaticwm for the parting guest. I doubt if it can mean ‘bread’.

There are several methods in vogue in the Near East of making bread; the commone shape is that of the flat disk of thin bread varying in size, but usually about This is probably one of the earliest forms of bread, and it is shown on the Hitt where two kings (?) are sharing a feast with this bread piled up in front of the see Garstang, Land of the Hittites, pl. xxv); the rounds of bread are to-day pil flat circular tray-basket (called sufrah). In S. Mesopotamia the oven (¢annur), bakers’ shops or on the decks of the larger boats, is roughly dome-shaped, eithe top, or closed, having a circular orifice of 18” diameter at one side. The fuel from the top, the fire flares up within, and the walls of the oven are thus heat then kneads the flour (¢aZ) in a green glazed bowl (madjen), or a copper bowl (c injanah), and after the kneading, the leaven (Zamrah, simple dough from yesterda is added. If no leaven has been retained from yesterday, the dough is left unlea

baker then makes small cakes (sazak) of this dough, which he pats out to a thin 10” diameter, which he slaps from hand to hand, and this he plasters on the inne the oven, where it is baked in about a minute. Ovens exactly like these were dis Dr. H. R. Hall in his excavations at Ur in 1919.

The Arab of the Sinaitic desert makes his pancake of bread rather thicker, and c in the ashes (the aka/ tumrz of p. 79). The more civilized Arab of the poorer cl

bakes the pancake on a convex iron plate over the fire. Still more primitive is the E. Sudan, who wraps his dough round stones and toasts it in front of the fir Pilgrim’s Scrip, 162). For the process in general, see the excellent article ‘ B Wm. Smith’s Dictionary of the Bible). In our text first the ‘rations’ (kurummatu §ab(p)us(s, Jat, a difficult word. Haupt (/¢. 25) compares Talmud s%éées ‘to con translates ‘was made up’. Sabésu is used of dust, in Maklu, I, 133, and VI, §5, for magic, with equivalent za-... in the Maku Commentary, KAR. 94, 11. Sad(p)ulu is a possible comparison (preceded by vatéu, Br. 5205). But none of these find a comparison in the other Semitic languages; the expected meaning might be ‘ground ‘rubbed into flour’. Next it is mussukat; cf SE.BA.LA.GIM = sim massikti (u. R. 16, g+ Rm. 619), perhaps = Syr. m’sak ‘become thin’ (i.e. ‘ground (?)’ or ‘sifte whatever be the processes described by Sadusat and mussukat, they precede the mo (ratbat) when it becomes dough: it is then kneaded into a cake (<ptest hamansu, ‘crush’, Arab. fasa’a ‘rub’; hardly the ¢e-f2-2s of CZ. xxi, 43, 6, ‘thou shalt think, as Haupt, the Arab. dada’a ‘divide’). Then she adds S7ba ([sz]fa, 1. 227) be ‘leaven’ (not, I think, ‘grease’, as Haupt), connected with s#u ‘old’, the ol yesterday, the Syr. s2éh, in pael sayyed ‘ contaminavit’ (comparable to the effe W. Smith, Dzc/. of Bible, ii, 85). Lastly it is baked (Haupt correctly). Note Ex that the people took their dough before it was leavened; and, if we are to take days’ of Uta-napishtim seriously, it must be remembered that the leavened mass w in other parts of the Near East to stand for some time, even for a whole night (Luke xiii, 21; Hos. vii, 6, quoted Smith, Dzct. of Bridle, I, 227).

220. An-ni-mis (Sit, rid) or an (for ana) ni-Sit. Adverbial? See Haupt, 7A. xxxu

221. Taddikannt, 1, 2 from adtké (with J.) ‘rouse’. But edakka in line 224 must the same root.

231. /kkimu ‘a robber’, not easily explicable.

237. Lktasu-u, parallel to masku-u in line 238, asking a question.

259. Lllika(ka) tnaha tSuta ‘cometh (goeth) all weary with rowing’, three verbs. cf. Heb. Sayzt ‘ rowing’ and sétim ‘rowers’ (J.). Actually he had been poling (i punt-pole).

272. Gilgamish follows the custom of the pearl-divers of Bahrain, long celebrate pearl-fisheries. In 1916 it fell to my lot in Basrah to interrogate some pearl-m wished to return to Lingah, and they told me that the diver descends with a clip and with one foot in the loop of a rope to which is attached a heavy stone, weig four Stambul okes at one end, the other end being held by a friend above. The ba collecting the pearls is slung about the diver’s neck, and he has also another r him, which is also held by his friend above, by which he signals to be hauled up that the men could go down to a depth of twenty fathoms, and make forty descents which seems an exaggeration. One of the divers spoke with an habitual breathless had been burnt in front of the ears, probably to cure some ear trouble. Percival Account of the Island of Ceylon (1803), gives an account of the divers there usi to accelerate their descent, the other details being similar to the above.

289. Kulultum, perhaps kuliptum, with Albright, RA. 1919, 189, ‘it shed a skin’, is, exhibiting a fresh youth after eating the plant. See also Jensen, OZLZ. 1929 am now more inclined to agree with it. At the same time, £u/zptc-sw would have s been preferable.

203-294. Ana manni-ia, the -ta seeming to mark a vocative, as perhaps in /52//an Tablet VI, 68, but hardly the Arab. 3.

298. For this incident, cf. p. 83.

302-307. These lines may be compared with Tablet I, Col. I, at end.